

XENON ENTERPRISE CONSULTING - GRANTS & FUNDING KNOWLEDGE BASE

Compiled from Past Conversations (January 2026)

Updated: January 30, 2026 — VDOT Retrospective POC Added

PART 1: COMPANY PROFILE & CREDENTIALS

Company Information

- **Legal Name:** XENON ENTERPRISE CONSULTING, INCORPORATED
- **Location:** 8119 Braidstone Ter, Chesterfield, VA 23838
- **Principal:** Lestin P. Jackson, MBA
- **Virginia SCC Registration:** Active (Entity ID: 07818149)
- **Established:** 2019

Federal Registration (SAM.gov) - ACTIVE as of January 14, 2026

- **UEI:** QMNZA26MEVP1
- **CAGE Code:** 8CLJ3
- **Status:** Active (Expires January 12, 2027)
- **Business Designation:** Minority-Owned Small Business
- **NAICS Codes:** 541512 (Computer Systems Design), 541611 (Management Consulting), and 4 others
- **PSC Codes:** 7F20 (IT Management), 7A20 (Application Development), and 6 others

Principal Credentials

- **Education:** MBA Finance, BS Mathematics/Computer Science
- **Certifications:** TOGAF, AWS Solutions Architect Professional, Generative AI Certification
- **Experience:** 20+ years Fortune 500 & Federal government
- **Key Roles:**
 - Senior Director, Finance IT Platforms - Hertz Corporation (2022-2024)
 - IT Consultant/Enterprise Architect - Virginia DOT (2024-2025)
 - **Co-Author, VDOT HMMS System Review (June 2025) ← KEY POC**

- Enterprise Architect - CMS, Blue Cross Blue Shield, Disney
 - Established EA Practice - Virginia DSS (2004-2011)
-

PART 2: GRANT FUNDING STRATEGY

VIPC (Virginia Innovation Partnership Corporation)

Commonwealth Commercialization Fund (CCF)

- **Award Range:** \$100K - \$300K (across three tiers)
- **Application:** Rolling basis
- **Timeline:** 45-60 days turnaround
- **Focus:** Technology commercialization
- **Tiers:**
 - Tier 1: Up to \$100K (early validation, TRL 2-4)
 - Tier 2: Up to \$200K (working prototype, TRL 4-6)
 - Tier 3: Up to \$300K (advanced commercialization, TRL 6-8)

VIPC Launch Programs

- **Launch Grant:** \$50K available quarterly
- **Launch Note:** Up to \$150K (convertible note, 20% discount, 4% interest, 3-year VA HQ requirement)

Combined VIPC Opportunity: Up to \$500K

- CCF: \$300K
- Launch Grant: \$50K
- Launch Note: \$150K

Target Request for Initial Application: \$250,000

- **Company Match:** \$150,000 (consulting revenue)
- **Total Project:** \$400,000
- **Project Duration:** 12 months

NSF SBIR (Small Business Innovation Research)

Status (as of January 2026)

- Legislative authority expired October 1, 2025
- Pending Congressional reauthorization (expected Q1-Q2 2026)
- NSF resumed processing previously-received pitches

When Reauthorized

- **Phase I:** \$275K for 6-12 months of R&D
- **Phase II:** Up to \$1M for continued development

AI Topic Alignment

- Deep learning-based AI systems
- AI systems interacting with humans in personalized contexts
- Cutting-edge applications of AI

NSF Application Fields (Now Completable with SAM.gov)

- Legal Business Name: XENON ENTERPRISE CONSULTING, INCORPORATED
- UEI: QMNZA26MEVP1
- CAGE Code: 8CLJ3
- Tax ID (EIN): [Last 4: 3871]
- Business Structure: Corporation, For-Profit
- Minority-Owned: Yes

Other Virginia Programs

- **CIT GAP Funds:** Up to \$150K for early-stage technology companies
 - **Virginia SBIR Matching Fund:** Matches federal SBIR awards dollar-for-dollar
 - **Virginia Tech LAUNCH POC Grant:** \$25K-50K (requires VT faculty partner)
 - **Regional Innovation Fund:** Various amounts
-

PART 3: VIPC APPLICATION CONTENT

Executive Summary Structure

The Problem

Enterprise architecture capability assessments are essential for IT modernization but prohibitively expensive and slow:

- **Cost:** \$500K-\$750K for comprehensive assessments
- **Time:** 6-8 months
- **Result:** Outdated before implementation begins
- **Root Cause:** Labor-intensive manual analysis requiring scarce TOGAF-certified expertise

Real Example: The VDOT HMMS assessment (where Lestin served as co-author) took 8 months, 6 FTEs, and cost an estimated \$717,500.

Virginia Context

- Limited IT budgets + modernization mandates (Executive Order 19, Commonwealth Digital Service)
- \$2.1 billion in annual IT spending requires data-driven decisions
- Traditional assessment costs consume 5-10% of transformation budgets

Our Solution

AI-driven platform automating enterprise architecture capability assessments:

- **Time Reduction:** 8 months → 3 months (62% faster)
- **Cost Reduction:** \$717K → \$182K (75% savings)
- **Effort Reduction:** 4,650 hours → 1,012 hours (78% less)
- **Architecture:** Multi-agent AI (LangGraph, CrewAI, Llama 3.1)

Key Capabilities

1. **Intake Agent** - Document classification, chunking, entity extraction
2. **Discovery Agent** - Capability and technology discovery from documents
3. **Assessment Agent** - CMM-style maturity scoring with consistent criteria
4. **Reporting Agent** - Automated report generation with citations

Budget Structure (Year 1: \$400K)

Personnel: \$142,000 (36%)

- Senior Software Engineer (FT): \$65,000
- Enterprise Architecture SME (PT): \$30,000
- Business Development Manager (PT): \$25,000
- Operations Manager (PT): \$12,000
- Marketing (PT): \$10,000

Technology: \$63,000 (16%)

- AWS Infrastructure: \$24,000
- SaaS Subscriptions: \$10,000
- Security Tools: \$8,000
- Development Tools: \$12,000
- Ardoq Integration: \$9,000

Business Development: \$45,000 (11%)

- Conference Sponsorships: \$15,000
- Marketing Collateral: \$8,000
- Lead Generation: \$6,000
- Demo Development: \$10,000
- Promotional Materials: \$6,000

Professional Services: \$55,000 (14%)

- Legal: \$15,000
- Accounting: \$8,000
- Patent Application: \$15,000
- Insurance: \$8,000
- Consulting: \$9,000

Founder Compensation: \$25,000 (6%)

Working Capital: \$70,000 (17%)

TOTAL: \$400,000

Milestone-Based Disbursement (VIPC \$250K)

Tranche 1: Month 1 - \$37,500 (15%)

- Legal entity formation complete
- AWS infrastructure deployed
- RAG document pipeline operational
- First pilot customer LOI signed
- DevOps pipeline deployed

Tranche 2: Month 4 - \$100,000 (40%)

- 2-agent system operational (Intake + Discovery)
- Senior Software Engineer hired
- 1 pilot customer assessment underway
- Technology debt scoring module operational
- EA SME engaged

Tranche 3: Month 7 - \$62,500 (25%)

- 2 customer pilots completed (case studies delivered)
- Full 4-agent platform operational
- BDM hired and trained
- Ardoq integration demonstrated
- Provisional patent application filed

Tranche 4: Month 10 - \$50,000 (20%)

- 5 total customers acquired (\$375K revenue)
- SOC 2 Type II audit initiated
- Post-implementation validation framework operational
- Year 2 scaling plan presented
- NSF SBIR Phase I application submitted (if pursuing)

Revenue Projections

Year 1

- 5 Virginia agencies @ \$75K average = \$375K revenue

Year 2

- 20 customers (10 state, 5 federal, 5 enterprise) @ \$75K = \$1.5M revenue

Year 3

- 55 customers + recurring subscriptions + professional services = \$4.2M revenue

Virginia Economic Impact

Job Creation

- Year 1: 3 FTE @ \$95K average
- Year 2: 8 FTE
- Year 3: 15 FTE
- Year 5: 30+ FTE target
- All positions Virginia-based

Tax Revenue (5-Year Cumulative)

- Corporate income tax: \$280,000
- Employee income tax: \$300,000
- Sales tax: \$60,000
- **Total: \$640,000**

Government Efficiency Impact

- **Direct Savings:** 5 agencies avoid \$2.5M+ in traditional consulting fees
 - **Time Savings:** 25+ weeks recovered in Year 1
 - **Statewide Impact:** If 10 assessments/year use CAF = \$5.35M annual savings
-

PART 4: PROOF OF CONCEPT — VDOT HMMS RETROSPECTIVE

Overview

The founder served as **co-author and Enterprise Architect** on the Virginia Department of Transportation's Highway Maintenance Management System (HMMS) assessment. This real, completed engagement provides concrete evidence of the problem CAF solves.

Report: HMMS Research Report, June 16, 2025 **Authors:** Lori Richter, Jason DiNatale, Lestin Jackson

The Manual Assessment (Actual Results)

Metric	Value
Duration	8 months
Team size	6 FTEs
Total effort	~4,650 hours
Estimated cost	\$717,500 (at \$150/hr)
Documents reviewed	100+
Capabilities assessed	13
Findings produced	40
Recommendations	45
Final report	115+ pages

AI-Assisted Assessment (Projected)

Metric	Value	Improvement
Duration	3 months	62% faster
Team size	2-3 FTEs	50-67% smaller
Total effort	~1,012 hours	78% reduction
Estimated cost	\$181,800	75% savings

Activity-Level Automation Potential

Activity	Manual Hours	AI-Assisted Hours	Savings
Document review & extraction	800	40	95%
Capability identification	300	20	93%
Maturity scoring	500	40	92%
Survey/ticket analysis	350	24	93%
Gap identification	400	24	94%
Report writing (draft)	800	80	90%
Cross-referencing findings	300	24	92%

Pain Points Identified (Automation Opportunities)

1. **Survey Distribution & Collation** — 200+ hours manually collating responses across 9 districts
2. **Maturity Level Determination** — 400+ hours of subjective deliberation with no standardized rubric
3. **Technical Artifact Analysis** — 500+ hours requesting and analyzing fragmented documentation
4. **Cross-Referencing Findings** — 300+ hours manually connecting themes across data sources
5. **Report Generation** — 800+ hours compiling 115+ page report

HMMS Assessment Deliverables

- Executive Summary
- 40 Key Findings (across 5 themes: System, Training, Data, Vendor, Policy)
- 45 Recommendations
- Current State Context Diagrams
- Capability Maturity Assessments (13 capabilities)
- State DOT Benchmarking Analysis
- Survey Results Analysis
- IT Support Ticket Analysis (421 tickets)
- Vendor Assessment
- Desired State Context Diagram

Why This Matters for VIPC

- 1. **Real engagement** — Not hypothetical; documented with Lestin as co-author
 - 2. **Virginia-specific** — VDOT is a Virginia agency
 - 3. **Quantified pain** — 8 months, \$717K, 4,650 hours all documented
 - 4. **Methodology proven** — 13-capability framework developed and applied
 - 5. **Credibility** — Demonstrates deep domain expertise in EA assessment
-

PART 5: COMPETITIVE ADVANTAGES

Practitioner Experience (Not Just Consultant)

Factor	Big 4 Firms	Xenon
Actual EA assessments delivered	Consulting only	VDOT HMMS (2025), VA DSS (2004-2011)
Government + Commercial	Separate practices	20+ years both domains
Operational experience	Client dependent	\$8B+ payment platform at Hertz
Delivery model	Junior consultants	Principal-led, AI-augmented
Cost	\$300-500/hour	75% cost savings

First-Mover Advantage

- 18-month lead on potential competitors
- Virginia state agency relationships provide immediate pilot pipeline
- VDOT engagement demonstrates methodology already proven
- Patent application planned (provisional filing in Year 1)

Federal Market Readiness

- SAM.gov Active (UEI: QMNZA26MEVP1, CAGE: 8CLJ3) - January 14, 2026
- Minority-owned business certification
- Eligible for federal set-asides

Commitment to Virginia

- Lives in Chester, Virginia (Chesterfield County)
 - Virginia SCC registration since 2019
 - 15+ years serving Virginia state agencies (VDOT, DSS)
 - Incorporated in Virginia (not Delaware)
 - Banks with Virginia financial institutions
 - Prioritizes Virginia vendors
-

PART 6: PAST PERFORMANCE REFERENCES

Virginia Department of Transportation (2024-2025)

Role: IT Consultant/Enterprise Architect **Key Deliverable:** Co-author, HMMS System Review (June 2025)

Scope:

- 8-month capability assessment of HMMS
- 13 capabilities evaluated against CMM framework
- 40 findings, 45 recommendations
- Stakeholder surveys across 9 districts
- Support ticket analysis (421 tickets)
- State DOT benchmarking (WV, PA, MO)

Relevance:

- **This is the POC engagement** — proves the problem and the methodology
- Recent Virginia agency relationship
- Demonstrates current government sector effectiveness

Hertz Corporation (2022-2024)

Role: Senior Director, Finance IT Platforms

Scope:

- \$50M+ Oracle EBS to Fusion ERP migration
- \$8B+ annual revenue across 150+ countries
- Architecture Review Boards established

- Board presentations and stakeholder management
- Event-driven architectures using microservices

Relevance:

- Large-scale enterprise architecture leadership
- Payment platform managing ~90% of transaction revenue
- PCI compliance expertise

Virginia Department of Social Services (2004-2011)

Role: Enterprise Architect (Established EA Practice)

Scope:

- ACA Program payment subsidy processing
- Interactive Voice Response (IVR) system
- HIPAA-compliant handling of sensitive financial data
- Federal/State integrated systems
- Multi-system payment-related architecture

Relevance:

- Government payment systems expertise
- Highly regulated environment
- Built EA practice from scratch

Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (2018-2019)

Role: Enterprise Architect

Scope:

- Medicare/Medicaid payment systems architecture
- Healthcare system modernization
- Compliance frameworks

Relevance:

- Federal payment systems architecture
- Federal compliance expertise

PART 7: COMBINED FUNDING STRATEGY

Funding Synergy

- **VIPC:** \$250K
- **NSF SBIR Phase I:** \$275K (when reauthorized)
- **Company Match:** \$150K
- **Total Combined:** \$675K

Timeline

- VIPC enables development during SBIR review period
- Combined funding positions company for break-even by Year 2

ROI Justification for VIPC

- **Virginia Investment:** \$400K (Year 1)
- **Per-Assessment Savings:** \$535K (based on VDOT retrospective)
- **If 10 assessments/year use CAF:** \$5.35M annual savings to Virginia
- **VIPC ROI:** 13:1 in first year of statewide adoption

Additional Benefits

- Virginia becomes national model for AI-enabled government efficiency
- Attracts federal contracts to Commonwealth
- Creates high-paying tech jobs
- Positions Virginia as government AI leader

PART 8: TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE

Platform Components

Component	Technology	Rationale
Agent Orchestration	LangGraph, CrewAI	Complex workflows, multi-agent collaboration

Component	Technology	Rationale
LLM	Llama 3.1 70B	Open source, on-premises for government
Embeddings	BGE-large-en-v1.5	High-quality retrieval
Vector Database	Qdrant	Scalable, metadata filtering
Reranker	BGE-reranker-v2-m3	Improved retrieval precision
Deployment	Ollama (dev), vLLM (prod)	Cost-effective inference

Agent Architecture

- 1. **Intake Agent** — Document classification, chunking, entity extraction, embedding storage
- 2. **Discovery Agent** — Capability identification, technology mapping, dependency analysis
- 3. **Assessment Agent** — CMM maturity scoring, gap analysis, risk evaluation
- 4. **Reporting Agent** — Executive summary, detailed report, roadmap generation

Why Open Source LLM?

- **Data privacy:** All processing on-premises/private cloud
- **Government compliance:** No data sent to external APIs
- **Cost control:** No per-token charges at scale
- **Customization:** Fine-tuning on EA domain data possible

GitHub Repository

- **URL:** github.com/lestinj/capability-assessment-framework
- **Status:** Active development
- **Contents:** Agent code, architecture docs, VDOT retrospective

PART 9: KEY DATES & DEADLINES

Completed

-  SAM.gov Registration Active (January 14, 2026)
-  Virginia SCC Reinstated

-  VDOT HMMS Report Published (June 16, 2025)
-  GitHub Repository Created (January 2026)
-  VDOT Retrospective POC Documented (January 2026)

Upcoming

- VIPC Application: Target February 2026
- NSF SBIR: Upon Congressional reauthorization (expected Q1-Q2 2026)
- SAM.gov Renewal: Due before January 12, 2027

Reminders

- Quarterly VIPC progress reports required
 - Annual SAM.gov renewal required
 - NSF SBIR cost reimbursement requires \$30-50K float capital
-

PART 10: CONTACT & SUBMISSION INFORMATION

VIPC Contact

- Website: vipc.org
- Programs: Commonwealth Commercialization Fund, Launch Grant, Launch Note

NSF SBIR Contact

- Website: nsf.gov/eng/iip/sbir
- AI Topic alignment confirmed

Xenon Enterprise Consulting

- **Principal:** Lestin P. Jackson, MBA
- **Address:** 8119 Braidstone Ter, Chesterfield, VA 23838
- **SAM.gov UEI:** QMNZA26MEVP1
- **CAGE:** 8CLJ3

GitHub Repository

- **URL:** <https://github.com/lestinj/capability-assessment-framework>
- **Branch:** main

APPENDIX: KEY METRICS SUMMARY

VDOT Retrospective Metrics (For Grant Applications)

Metric	Manual	AI-Assisted	Improvement
Duration	8 months	3 months	62% faster
Effort	4,650 hours	1,012 hours	78% less
Cost	\$717,500	\$181,800	75% savings
Team	6 FTEs	2-3 FTEs	50-67% smaller
Per-Assessment Savings	—	\$535,700	—

Virginia Impact Projections

Metric	Value
Statewide annual savings (10 assessments)	\$5.35M
Jobs created (Year 5)	30+
Tax revenue (5-year)	\$640K
Time recovered annually	50+ weeks

Document compiled January 25, 2026 Updated January 30, 2026 — VDOT Retrospective POC added, Air Force contract reference removed For internal use in VIPC application development